the village of martyrs, because almost every family had someone who fought or died in Indian-administered Kashmir, mainly with Lashkar.[93]

The group compensated its recruits well. Salaries are estimated to have ranged from Rs10,000 to Rs20,000 per month along with an end of tenure payment of between Rs300,000 to Rs500,000 for every year of 'active' service in the Kashmir jihad.[94] Lashkar also compensated a recruit's family if he died in combat. Through the Wurasa Shuhda-O-Ghazian [Kin of Martyrs and Fighters], the group offered assistance to the relatives of the martyrs of Kashmir. This included monthly stipends and other facilities.[95] It also cared for veterans and arranged jobs for those who could work.[96] Providing such financial support, along with maintaining the group's myriad training and social service networks, required a robust fundraising infrastructure. In the early 1990s, members of the group were forced to ask their friends to help finance the organization, but by the decade's end it had put those penurious days behind it.[97]

Lashkar received a fair amount of financial assistance from the army and ISI, but the group also developed a financial network of its own within the country. This network was managed by MDI's Department of Finance, which had a section devoted to collecting funds for the jihad in Kashmir. Every year the group solicited the hides of animals sacrificed for the Muslim holy festival of Eid al-Adha and then sold those hides for a large profit. Over time, the group developed a sophisticated collection strategy. One Pakistani citizen from whom the group solicited a hide described the process: he received a package several days before the holiday began containing a bag for a hide along with a brochure stating 'If you support the dominance of Islam then help us.' The bag came with the names and numbers of different functionaries responsible for collecting the hides from people in various zones in his city. This not only made for an orderly collection process, but also enabled the group to build a database of donors who responded.[98]

This was only one of many fundraising methods. Until its ban in 2002 Lashkar placed donation boxes to solicit funds in countless shops throughout Pakistan. Following a brief absence after the ban, these donation boxes returned, and were still present at the time of the author's last visit in May 2009. Staff members also collected money at MDI offices, through personal solicitations and at public gatherings to celebrate a